

Google TV's companion box - the 'Logitech Revue' unveiled



Logitech's Google TV set top box, or companion box as it is called, has been made official, and it is called the Logitech Revue with Google TV. Due to be released in the American Fall, the Revue will apparently combine your TV, DVR recordings and the entire internet.

Logitech has reportedly employed an imaginary tagline describing the virtues of the Logitech Revue as, "If you can think it, you can watch it", which means you can search for and tune to that particular channel using the universally acclaimed Google search engine interface on your TV! What's more, you can also tune

to your favorite TV shows, and schedule certain shows for recording. These recorded and saved shows are stored in the list format for future access. Google TV also ships with a web browser, which allows you to browse video albums and online content including your favorite videos under the favorite list. In addition, you could check your online fantasy team stats, while you are watching your favorite football match on the same screen in split-screen mode. Thus, the browser and the TV work hand in hand to deliver amazing out of the box experience. Google TV also includes customiza-

tion options to organize your TV channels with captions and names, organize your photos, videos and music playlists summing up to be a complete home entertainment device for the next generation.

Most new TVs are said to ship with 'Google TV' pre-installed on them or you could buy a separate box that fits into the TV, you already own. Apart



Logitech Revue with Google TV - the envisioned ecosystem

from the companion box, the device also features an "intuitive controller" (which combines a compact keyboard, remote control and touchpad), the Logitech Revue will apparently give you access to the features that Logitech is known for, from peripherals to video calling, entertainment control to streaming media, and new smartphone applications such as Logitech Harmony Link - an IR signal translator meant to control the companion box via a smartphone that has infrared capabilities. Due to this versatile nature, it has been reportedly named the Revue, along the lines of the theatre style popular in the Modern European Drama of the early 1900s, known for its multi-act nature.

In the meanwhile, Logitech wants you to think of the Revue this way:

"Google TV = seamless discovery of content. Logitech + Google TV = seamless control over how you experience the discovery of content."

Google opens a new portal to cloud nirvana - free online YouTube Video Editor

In an era of fast changing technology and rapidly growing strength of internet revolution, we are moving closer to the cloud nirvana. As more and more cloud apps make their presence felt, the potential everyday apps are getting popular indeed! While free apps are more welcome than the paid ones, the quality apps generally come at a premium price. But, a revolutionary cloud based YouTube Video Editor from Google, promises to change

the scenario by offering its services free of cost. No wonder, this news would make a lot of buzz in the market and not to forget the infinite possibilities that cloud concept brings with it!

Recently, Google reported that they were testing their own web based YouTube video editor app. The application primarily provides the privilege to edit YouTube videos, with the following feature enhancements:

- Trimming the beginning and/or end of a video

- Split/join YouTube videos to produce a new video
- Replace original soundtracks to the videos from the AudioSwap library. However, one should note that only one song can be added to a video at a time and the replaced original soundtracks cannot be recovered.
- Create new videos and publish to YouTube without having to bother about the file format or worry about uploading them.

YouTube Video Editor promises ease and fun with

usage. Aspiring users can give the YouTube Video Editor a try in the TestTube (a YouTube ideas incubator), where budding YouTube apps are tried and tested before coming out of the cocoon. CaptionTube, Video annotations, HTML5 video are some of the other upcoming TestTube projects in their beta stage. YouTube promises to open a new portal to cloud nirvana with constant upgrades and improvements, along the lines of open source mantra!